

"Guests are blown away. Most have ever had any choice beyond he standard still, sparkling or tap. They are fascinated to meet a certified water ommelier and learn about each water's source—hether it's a spring, artesian well, glacier, rainwater, or even mist and to hear bout its geological journey that gives it its unique mineral profile,"
says Cameron Smith

complete with tasting notes, mineral analysis, and bottle photography.

YES, WATER HAS TASTE!

Like wine, unprocessed water carries a distinct terroir dictated by Total Dissolved Solids (TDS) which is the concentration of minerals, salts and metals absorbed from the earth. "These natural elements can render a sip unexpectedly fruity, distinctly salty or even slightly bitter. A low TDS offers crisp, neutral lightness whereas a high TDS yields a bold, almost savoury profile. To put things in perspective, distilled water carries a TDS of zero, while seawater sits at a dense 30,000," explains India's first certified water sommelier Ganesh Iyer.

Beyond TDS, pH levels define the finish. High-alkaline waters are prized for a velvety, slightly sweet mouthfeel, while Zero Nitrate levels signal a source untouched by pollutants for centuries. "No two natural waters are identical, even if sourced just two metres apart. Seasonal shifts like rainfall and petrichor alter the minerality underground, changing the taste entirely," says Avanti Mehta, India's youngest water sommelier. Her family owns the Aava mineral water brand.

THE ART OF WATER PAIRING

Water pairing is becoming as precise as wine service, governed by a simple rule: match the water's weight to the dish's intensity. A low-TDS still water is the ideal companion for delicate raw seafood, as its neutral profile won't mask the ingredients. Conversely, a high-mineral, naturally carbonated water provides the sharp contrast needed to cut through the richness of a prime rib or aged wagyu. "A naturally carbonated water with good sodium pairs perfectly with the rawness of a seafood salad," says Iyer. "For a robust biryani, a natural mineral water with a TDS of 220-350 mg, like Veen, is better. If you prefer bubbles with a barbeque, go for something with a larger carbonation like San Pellegrino." For dessert, Iyer suggests